

- 4.If you have turned on the access list, make sure that the clients' IP addresses and MAC addresses match those in the access points list.
- 5.Check for disturbances caused by other devices such as microwaves or cordless phones that work on the 2.4 GHz frequency.
- 6.Make sure your clients are as close as possible to the access point when configuring them. Obstructions such as walls could block the signal.
- 7.Make sure all the cards connected to the computers have the correct drivers loaded and are enabled.
- 8.If you have enabled WEP, as you should, turn it off and see if the clients connect. If they do, you have a network strength problem.
- 9.Change the position of the access point's antenna and try to get a better signal.
10. If you are having signal strength problems, consider getting a better antenna-the default 4 dBi antenna can be upgraded to as much as 24 dBi. You could also consider getting a directional antenna, which would concentrate the signal in one direction.
11. Update the OS on the clients. Windows XP SP2, for example, comes with better Wi-Fi support and inbuilt support for WPA.

Any advice for first timers?

Yes, tons! We'll take this opportunity to give you a set of more comprehensive troubleshooting tips than the short list above:

Though manufacturers have put a lot of effort into making WLAN setups easy and quick, there are times when a few hiccups